

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills for presenting complex scientific evidence to legal experts.



The ability to work as part of an investigative team made up of scientists and police.



Excellent analytical skills and absolute attention to detail when examining evidence.



A logical and methodical approach to build a probable sequence of events in a crime case.

PUBLIC HEALTH FORENSIC SCIENTIST Works with health or government organizations to locate the sources of environmental contamination or investigate the causes of disease epidemics.



FORENSIC EXPLOSIVES SPECIALIST Uses chemical analysis to establish both the cause of an explosion and the origin of the chemicals involved in it.



Fingerprint evidence has been used in court for over a century.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **INTELLIGENCE OFFICER** *see pp. 246–247*
- ▶ **BIOCHEMIST** Investigates chemical reactions that take place inside living organisms. Research areas include DNA, proteins, drugs, and disease.
- ▶ **LABORATORY TECHNICIAN** Supports scientists during laboratory investigations. They prepare samples for analysis, carry out experiments, and maintain laboratory equipment and supplies.
- ▶ **PATHOLOGY TECHNICIAN** Supports doctors during postmortem examinations to identify the cause of a person's death.
- ▶ **TOXICOLOGIST** Conducts experiments to determine the impact of toxic and radioactive materials on people, animals, and the environment.

AT A GLANCE



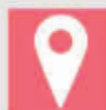
YOUR INTERESTS Chemistry • Biology • Mathematics • Physics • Information Technology (IT) • Research and laboratory work



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree in a relevant science subject is usually required, while a graduate degree in forensic science is useful.



LIFESTYLE Hours of work are variable because call-outs to crime scenes can come at any time, including evenings and weekends.



LOCATION Most work is carried out in a laboratory, although visits to crime scenes and courts to present evidence are also a crucial part of the role.



THE REALITIES Visiting accident or crime scenes can be distressing. Forensic scientists have to keep up to date with the changing technology.